



**Canterbury
Christ Church
University**

**Module Handbook for International Human Resource Management Academic
Year 2024/25**

Module code: P14241

Level of study: 7

Number of credits: 20 credit module

Course/s the module belongs to: MSc International Business and MBA
International

Faculty: Science, Engineering and Social Sciences

Semester/Trimester of delivery: Advent Trimester (September-January)

Start date of the module: September 2024

Location of study: Canterbury

Study hours for the module: 200 hours - Divide into:

- **Number of contact hours and pattern of delivery:** 30 taught hours scheduled contact, one-hour guided learning and two hours face-to-face seminar
- **Number of hours when students are expected to study independently or amongst peers, with no direct academic contact:** 170 hours of independent ¹ study.

How to access tutorials and other module support: Essential materials are available on the blackboard to prepare you for your sessions and support your independent learning. Please visit the module blackboard regularly for news and updates.

Who is the module for? This module is a core module for Level 7 students on the MBA International and MSc International Business courses.

Module aims

1. To enable students to develop the knowledge, skills and confidence to deliver effective managerial responsibility either in a broad or generalist sense.
2. To contribute significantly to the development of human resource strategy and practices in organisations operating or wishing to operate in the international arena.

Module learning outcomes: By the end of this module, students should be able to:

1. Demonstrate a critical awareness of current problems in the discipline of International Human Resource Management by evaluating current business and management theory and practice in the field.
2. Understand and critically evaluate the ways in which International Human Resource Management strategies, policies and practices contribute to the broader objectives and strategies of international business.
3. Distinguish between international approaches to managing people, economic governance, labour market regulations and industrial relations. In addition, students should be able to demonstrate why systems vary between nations.
4. Identify the principal components within the role of international manager and the key challenges that they face. In addition, communicate appropriately proposed international human resource solutions on complex issues clearly and understood by non-experts in the field.
5. Explain and evaluate contemporary developments in international regulations and labour standards and the ethical implications of international business. They will demonstrate originality of thinking in proposing credible, workable solutions to an International Human Resource Management problem.

Overview of learning and teaching activities on the module: A range of teaching and blended learning strategies will be used including online lectures, interactive workshops, guided study, focused readings, student presentations, tutorials and illustrative case-study analysis. Students will have the opportunity to offer evidence from their own experiences where this is relevant and will critically examine strategic issues from other organisations. There will be a focus on team collaboration in reflecting and building upon contextual compositions of student background and

competencies. Independent learning will be encouraged as well as teamwork reflecting individual and collective cultural background.

Equipment you need to bring to class Please ensure you bring along writing equipment (Pen and paper) or laptop. It is not recommended to just use your mobile phone.

Indicative schedule of delivery:

Session	Indicative Content	Independent Study Activities
Week 1 W/b 23/09/2024	Welcome to the module	See the module blackboard for weekly activities
Week 2 W/b 30/09/2024	Introduction to International Human Resource Management	
Week 3 W/b 07/10/2024	Strategic Approach to International Human Resource Management	
Week 4 W/b 14/10/2024	Industry Characteristics, Organisational and National Culture	
Week 5 W/b 21/10/2024	Academic Development Week (no lessons this week)	
Week 6 W/b 28/10/2024	Institutional Environment and Unionisation	Presentations
Week 7 W/b 04/11/2024	Recruitment, Selection and the Labour Market	
Week 8 W/b 11/11/2024	Training and Development	
Week 9 W/b 18/11/2024	Reward and Performance Management	
Week 10 W/b 25/11/2024	International Staffing and Employee Voice	
Week 11 W/b 02/12/2024	Review of the Module	
Week 12 W/b 09/12/2024	Assignment support	

Guidance on how to use independent study time: Please refer to the module blackboard for weekly activities.

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Referencing system: Please use the Harvard Referencing System for all work on this module. For help with this please visit, <http://www.canterbury.ac.uk/library/docs/harvard.pdf>

Or Cite them Right, <https://www.citethemrightonline.com/> (access available through Blackboard)

Assessments:

Summative assessment Type	% weighting	Deadline for submission of work and where assignment should be submitted	Date for return of mark/grade and feedback and where they will be returned	Minimum pass mark for assessment task(s)
1.Group Presentation (Equivalent to 1,600 words)	40%	Monday 28th October 2024. Each member of the group will individually submit a copy of the PowerPoint Presentation electronically via Turnitin on Blackboard by 2pm and presented in the seminar that week	Immediate verbal feedback from tutor and peers in class. Grade and further feedback via Turnitin on 18 th November 2024	50%
2. Case Study (2,400 words)	60%	Friday 13th December 2024 submitted electronically via Turnitin on Blackboard on 2pm	Grade and feedback via Turnitin on 15 th January 2025	50%

It is important that you meet your assessment deadline to help manage your workload and ensure your timely progression to your next level of study. However, we understand that in exceptional cases you may be unable to submit your work on time or do well in your exams due to unexpected events which are short-term in nature and beyond your control. Find out more about what to do in situations such as these [here](#).

A coursework extension or a chance to re-take your exam is not an automatic right; and to ensure fairness and transparency, exceptional circumstances requests will only be approved if they meet the criteria, are submitted on time and - where relevant - include appropriate professional evidence.

Assessment briefs:

Summative Assessment 1 – submit via Turnitin on 28th October 2024 by 2pm:

Group Presentation (40% - equivalent of 1,600 words)

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Conduct a **15-minute group presentation** on the **internal factors** that could impact upon the HR strategy of BrazilCo. who has a subsidiary in another country. Students should **choose one of BrazilCo.'s subsidiaries** to answer this assignment. Students are expected to critically engage with factors within the organisation that could impact upon this decision.

Students will need to read the full case study in order to answer this assignment. See the module blackboard for the Journal Article regarding BrazilCo. [File \(canterbury.ac.uk\)](http://canterbury.ac.uk)

Guidance:

This assessment provides you with the opportunity to understand the multinational company and the internal aspects of the organisation that impact the development of its strategic human resource management. It is expected that as part of this presentation students will engage with theoretical/academic sources to support assertions. There is freedom as to how the presentation is structured, though. There will be around 5 minutes for questions. **Each student should submit a copy of their group's presentation, in order to received a grade and feedback which will support your knowledge and development for your final assignment.**

This assignment is a group presentation and as such, each group should work together and equitably. The lecturer reserves the right to mark group members individually if evidence is produced of members not working together collaboratory within the group.

Marking Criteria for Summative Assessment 1: (See the full Level 7 Criteria at the back of the Course Handbook for the breakdown of the criterion grade barriers)

CRITERION		WEIGHTING
A. CONTENT, KNOWLEDGE and UNDERSTANDING		10%
2a. Information gathering/processing	Use of initiative to seek out sources of information and new insights. Ability to effectively evaluate the information validity against existing information.	
B. COGNITIVE SKILLS		15%
5. Referencing	Use of sources to support discussion and personal findings. Referencing follows the Harvard Referencing System	
6b. Attention to purpose	Addresses the purpose of the assignment	
9. Conclusions	Developed conclusions grounded in theory and/or evidence and/or literature	
C. PRACTICAL SKILLS		40%
13. Performance	Performance demonstrates communication, commitment and understanding of the subject with attention to detail and displaying technical ability. Well-rehearsed, assured presentation.	
D. TRANSFERABLE SKILLS		35%
19. Presentation (oral)	Clear structure and addresses specialist and non-specialist audience. Evidence good pace and audibility.	
20. Interactive and group skills (including teamwork, negotiation, understanding group dynamics and empathy)	Interacts effectively within a learning group, giving and receiving information and ideas. Negotiates and handles group dynamics, such as handling conflict and establishing relationships which service the group needs.	
21. Self-presentation / interpersonal skills	5 Confident style of presentation and interpersonal skills with effective management throughout.	

Summative Assessment 2 – submitted via Turnitin 13th December 2024 by 2pm:

Case Study (60% - equivalent to 2,400 words)

Critically analyse the HRM challenges that BrazilCo. faced when setting up in one of their subsidiaries (in Canada, UK, Norway or Switzerland). Looking at both internal AND external factors that affected the HRM practices, and in particular, the cultural and institutional factors across these countries and on the issue of whether to integrate or differentiate their approach.

Guidance:

You are expected to critically analyse **AT LEAST** three of the following HRM areas in relation to your organisation and countries: recruitment and selection; training and development; performance management; reward management; or expatriation/staffing.

You are expected to show a strong understanding of these HRM areas in a general sense, as well as how they may differ across the two countries

You must discuss the relevant external factors in each of the countries and the opportunities and challenges that they caused for Brazil Co.

Ensure that you engage with academic literature both on international HRM more broadly and focusing on your specific countries.

Support the assertions you make about your MNC with practical examples. Ensure that any suggestions you offer are realistic and appropriate for their circumstances.

Marking Criteria for Summative Assessment 2: (See the full Level 7 Criteria at the back of the Module Handbook for the breakdown of the criterion grade barriers)

CRITERION		WEIGHTING
A. CONTENT, KNOWLEDGE and UNDERSTANDING		35%
1a. Content and range of knowledge displayed	Comprehensive, detailed and in-depth knowledge base, including new insights. Shows capacity to integrate theoretical and substantive knowledge, and the limits to knowledge.	
2c. Use of literature/evidence of reading	Broad and/or in-depth independent reading from appropriate sources. Clear, accurate, systematic application of material with developed and/or integrated critical appraisal.	
B. COGNITIVE SKILLS		35%
5. Referencing	Use of sources to support discussion and personal findings. Referencing follows the Harvard Referencing System	
6a. Clarity of objectives and focus of work	Defines appropriate objectives in detail and addresses them giving focus to the work.	
8b. Critical reasoning	Critical evaluation of recognised and current theories and/or concepts and/or assumptions and/or data which informs the approach taken to the assignment. Argument is clear and coherent.	
D. TRANSFERABLE SKILLS		30%

15b. Coherence and organisation of work	Demonstrates logical organisation and coherence in answering the assignment objectives	
16. Clarity of expression (incl. accuracy, spelling, grammar, punctuation)	Demonstrates fluent, effective writing with well-structured and coherent arguments. Writing style is adapted effectively to the needs of the brief using disciplinespecific vocabulary accurately to present ideas clearly.	

This assignment **is marked anonymously** information regarding anonymous marking can be found here <https://www.canterbury.ac.uk/our-students/ugcurrent/academic-services/assessments/exams-and-coursework-procedures> **Reassessment information:**

Some students may not pass an assessment first time and will be invited to take reassessment for the module, following a decision from a Board of Examiners. Do check the [Your Guide to Assessment and Award Processes](#) and seek advice from your Personal Academic Tutor if this is the case for you. Your module team will offer support in preparation for your reassessment.

In this case, the nature of the reassessment will be:

Original assessment	Reassessment type	Deadline for submission of reassessment, and where it should be submitted
1.Group Presentation	1.Individual Presentation	TBC May 2025
2.Case Study	2.Case Study	TBC May 2025

This handbook should be read in conjunction with other sources:

- Student Course Handbook: for course academic information applying to all modules
- [Current Student Webpages](#): for generic student experience information

Learning Materials/Resources:

Weekly learning resources are available within the 'Learning Resources and Activities' folder on the module Blackboard. Please ensure you look at these resources each week, so you are familiar with them.

Core Text:

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Brewster, C., Houldsworth, E., Sparrow, P., and Vernon, G. (2023) *International Human Resource Management*. Fifth Edition. London: Chartered Institute of Personnel and Development. **(Available in the Library)**

Essential Resources:

Edwards, T. and Rees, C. (2017). *International Human Resource Management: Globalization, National Systems and Multinational Companies*. Third Edition. Harlow: Pearson Education Limited. **(available as an e-book through the library)**

Reiche, B. S., Harzing, A-W., and Tenzer, H. (Eds.) (2022) *International Human Resource Management*. Sixth Edition. London: SAGE Publications Limited. **(Available in the Library)**

Reiche, B. S., Stahl, G. K., Mendenhall, M. E. and Oddou, G. R. (Eds.) (2017). *Readings and Cases in International Human Resource Management*. Sixth Edition: Routledge. **(Available in the Library)**

Thompson, E., Worthington, I., and Britton, C. (2023) *The Business Environment: A Global Perspective*, Ninth Edition, Pearson. **(available as an e-book through the library)**

Wilton, N. (2022) *An Introduction to Human Resource Management*. London: SAGE Publications **(Available in the library)**

Recommended Resources:

Armstrong, M. and Taylor, S. (2020). *Armstrong's Handbook of Human Resource Management Practice*. Fifteenth Edition. London: KoganPage. **(Available in the library)**

Armstrong, M. (2021) *Armstrong's Handbook of Strategic Human Resource Management: Improve business performance through strategic people management*. Seventh Edition. London: KoganPage. **(Available in the library)**

Bratton, J. and Gold, J. (Eds.) (2017). *Human Resource Management: Theory and Practice*. Sixth Edition. London: Red Globe Press. **(available as an e-book through the library)**

Brooks, I., Weatherston, J. and Wilkinson, G. (2011). *The International Business Environment: Challenges and Changes*. Second Edition. Harlow: Pearson Education Limited. **(available as an e-book through the library)**

Daniels, J.D., Radebaugh, L.H. and Sullivan, D.P. (2019). *International Business: Environments and Operations*. Sixteenth Edition. Harlow: Pearson. **(available as an e-book through the library)**

Hill, C.W.L. (2023). *International Business: Competing in the Global Marketplace*. Fourteenth Edition. New York: McGraw Hill Education. **(Available in the library)**

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Hofstede, G. (2001). *Culture's Consequences: comparing values, behaviours, institutions and organisations across nations*. London: SAGE Publications. **(Available in the library)**

Marchington, M., Wilkson, A., Donnelly, R. and Kynighou, A. (2021). *Human Resource Management at Work: The Definitive Guide*. Seventh Edition. London: KoganPage. **(Available in the library)**

Nakata, C. (2009) *Beyond Hofstede culture frameworks for global marketing and management*. Palgrave Macmillan. **(available as an e-book through the library)**

Trompenaars, F. and Hampden-Turner, C. (2012). *Riding the Waves of Culture: Understanding Diversity in Global Business*. Third Edition. London: Nicholas Brealey Publishing. **(available as an e-book through the library)**

Weedon, C. (2004). *Identity and Culture*. Maidenhead: Open University Press. **(available as an e-book through the library)**

Journals:

Human Resource Management International Digest **(available online through the library)**

The International Journal of Human Resource Management **(available online through the library)**

International Journal of Cross Cultural Management **(available online through the library)**

International Organisation Websites

The United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD)
<https://unctad.org/>

CIPD International Research <https://www.cipd.co.uk/>

OCED Guidelines for Multinational Enterprises
<http://mneguidelines.oecd.org/annualreportsontheguidelines.htm>

The International Labour Organisation Publications and Reports
<https://www.ilo.org/global/publications/lang--en/index.htm>

The World Federation of People Management Associations website
<http://www.wfpma.com>

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